MIL-P-20338A(MU)
19 July 1967
SUPERSEDING
MIL-P-20338
27 November 1951

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PRIMER, PERCUSSION, MARK 2A4 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the loading, assembling and packing for one type of primer designated as Primer, Percussion, Mark 2A4.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-223 - Powder, Black.
MIL-A-2550 - Ammunition and Special Weapons; General Specification for.
MIL-I-45607 - Inspection Equipment, Supply and Maintenance of.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-109 - Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions.
MIL-STD-1168 - Lot Numbering of Ammunition.
MIL-STD-1235 - Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

FSC: 1390

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DRAWINGS

ARMY

8840362 - Primer, Percussion MK 2A4 Loading Assembly.
8860559 - Shipping and Storage Container, Fuze XM573 For Primer, Percussion, MK 2A4.
8860560 - Box, Wirebound, Packing Ammunition for Primer, Percussion, MK 2A4.

PUBLICATIONS

ARMY

ET-8840362 - Equipment Tabulation

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.-Materials and parts shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Primers.-The primers shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (dwg.) 8840362 and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Moisture content of black powder.-The moisture content of the black powder at the loading station, at the time of loading shall not exceed 0.5 percent when determined as specified in 4.3.2.

3.4 Non-functioning.-The primer, without the black powder charge, shall not function under an applied energy value of 24.51 inch ounces minimum (min.), when tested as specified in 4.3.3.

3.5 Functioning.

3.5.1 Without black powder.-The primers, without the black powder charge, shall function under an applied energy value of 147.06 inch ounces maximum (max.) when tested as specified in 4.3.3.1.

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3.5.2 With black powder.-The primers, with the black powder charge, shall fire and there shall be no blowbacks, perceptible hangfires, or metal parts separation; the primer must obturate and extract easily, when tested as specified in 4.3.3.2 (see 6.7 and 6.8).

3.6 Chamber gage.-The completed primer shall freely enter the prescribed chamber gage (see 4.2.3.4).

3.7 Workmanship.-All parts shall be dry and free of burrs, cracks, chips, dirt, grease, rust and other foreign matter prior to, and following the loading and assembling operations. The cleaning method shall not be injurious to any of the parts nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agents. All required markings shall be neat and sharply defined.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 General quality assurance provisions.-Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to Standard MIL-STD-109 in order to define terms used herein. The provisions of Specification MIL-A-2550 shall apply.

4.1.1 Submission of product.-At the time the completed lot of product is submitted to the Government for acceptance, the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all of the quality assurance provisions specified within this specification.

b. Number of units of product inspected.

c. Results obtained, by defect code, for all inspections performed.

d. Drawing, specification number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.

e. Certificates of conformance on all material purchased by the contractor when such material is controlled by Government or commercial specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents.

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f. Number of items in the lot.
g. Date submitted.

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.1.2 Government verification.-Using the contractor's written quality assurance procedure, this detailed specification, the applicable drawings and other contractual documents as a guide, the Government inspector shall verify at unscheduled intervals, all quality assurance operations performed by the contractor. Verification will be performed to the extent necessary to assure compliance with the contractual requirements. Severity of Government inspection of individual characteristics will be directly related to the seriousness of the classification assigned. In no instance will a characteristic classified "critical" be accepted solely on the basis of the contractor's records.

4.2 Inspection provisions

4.2.1 Lot formation.-The term "lot" as used throughout this specification refers to an inspection lot, which is defined as an essentially homogeneous collection of units of product from which a representative sample is drawn and inspected to determine conformance of the lot with applicable requirements. The sample selected shall represent only that quantity of units from which the sample was drawn and shall not be construed to represent any prior or subsequent quantities presented for inspection. Homogeneity shall be considered to exist provided the lot has been produced by one manufacturer, in one unchanged process, in accordance with the same drawing, same drawing revision, same specification and same specification revision. Changes to the process, specification, or drawing not affecting safety, performance, interchangeability, or storage, as determined by the Government, shall not be deemed to alter the homogeneity of the lot. Inspection lots shall comply with MIL-STD-105 and shall be numbered in accordance with MIL-STD-1168. Unless otherwise approved by the contracting officer, the inspection lot size of end items deliverable under the contract shall be not less than the smallest weekly estimate of quantities contractually scheduled for production during the

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contract period nor more than the largest monthly quantity contractually scheduled for delivery during the contract period. Inspection lots for components or subassemblies, other than the items of delivery, shall be homogeneous and of a size mutually convenient to both the contractor and the Government inspector. Each lot shall contain:

a. Percussion primers of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

b. Primer metal components of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

c. Black powder of one lot number from one manufacturer.

4.2.2 Examination.-Inspection for Critical defects (and Major defects, when so specified,) shall be 100 percent. Sampling plans and procedures for Major and Minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 except that continuous sampling plans in accordance with MIL-STD-1235 may be used if approved by the procuring activity. Also, at the option of the procuring activity, AQL's and sampling plans may be applied to individual characteristics listed using an AQL of 0.65 percent for each Minor defect and an AQL of 0.40 percent for each Major defect, except where 100 percent inspection is specified. Equipment necessary for the performance of the inspections listed shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.2.1 Primer prior to assembling of percussion element (see dwg. 8840362).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical: None defined.			
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Flash hole completely obstructed	Visual	01001
Minor: None defined.			

4.2.2.2 Primer prior to assembling of black powder (see dwg. 8840362).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:			
1.	Percussion element above flush with surface of head	Straight-Edge	02001

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Major:	AQL 0.65 percent		
101.	Percussion element missing, cracked or inverted or loose .	Visual	02002
102.	Crimp missing or improper	Visual	02003
103.	Seal missing or improper	Visual	02004
Minor:	AQL 1.0 percent		
201.	Closing disc plug missing or damaged	Visual	02005
202.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7)	Visual	02006

4.2.3.3 Primer prior to assembling primer closing disc (see dwg. 8840362).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined.		
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Weight of charge, min.	Balance	03001
Minor:	None defined.		

4.2.2.4 Primer (see dwg. 8840362).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined.		
Major:	AQL 0.65 percent		
101.	Total length, max.	Gage	04001
102.	Distance from primer closing disc to end of body, max.	Gage	04002
103.	Distance from flange end to percussion element	Gage	04003
104.	Primer closing disc seal missing or improper	Visual	04004
Minor:	AQL 1.0 percent		
201.	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable	Visual	04005
202.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7)	Visual	04006

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4.2.2.5 Box, packing (closed) (see dwg. 8860559).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined.		
Major:	AQL 0.65 percent		
101.	Hardware improperly engaged ..	Visual	05001
102.	Box dented or deformed	Visual	05002
103.	Box punctured	Visual	05003
Minor:	AQL 1.0 percent		
201.	Bare spot on exterior	Visual	05004
202.	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable	Visual	05005

4.2.2.6 Box packing (see dwg. 8860560).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined.		
Major:	AQL 1.0 percent		
101.	Wire missing, broken or loose.	Visual-Manual	06001
102.	Wire improperly secured	Visual	06002
103.	Contents exposed	Visual	06003
104.	Board broken or split	Visual	06004
105.	DOD symbol misleading or unidentifiable	Visual	06005
Minor:	AQL 1.5 percent		
201.	Contents loose when box is tilted	Manual	06006
202.	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable	Visual	06007
203.	Car seal missing, unsealed or improperly positioned	Visual	06008

4.2.3 Testing.-The test equipment shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.3.1 Non-functioning (see 3.4) Critical defect - Code No. 02007.

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4.2.3.1.1 Beginning with the first lot produced, and continuing until three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance criteria specified, a sample of 150 head assemblies shall be randomly selected from each lot for the test. If any sample fails to comply with requirements the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.2.

4.2.3.1.2 After three consecutive lots have met the criteria of 4.2.3.1.1, a sample of 50 head assemblies shall be randomly selected from each lot for this test. If one or more primers fail to comply with the applicable requirement, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.2 using equipment in accordance with 4.2.4. Primers subjected to this test shall be destroyed.

4.2.3.2 Functioning.

4.2.3.2.1 Without black powder charge (see 3.5.1) Major defect - Code No. 02008.

4.2.3.2.1.1 Beginning with the first lot produced and continuing until three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance criteria specified, three hundred primers shall be selected from each lot for this test. If five or more primers fail to comply with the specified requirements the lot shall be rejected. If two but less than five defectives are found a second sample of 600 primers shall be tested. If the combined number of defectives in both the first and second sample is 5 or more the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.3.1.

4.2.3.2.1.2 After three consecutive lots have met the criteria of 4.2.3.2.1.1, one hundred and twenty five primers shall be selected from each subsequent production lot for this test. If 2 or more primers fail to comply with the specified requirement the lot shall be rejected. If only one defective is found, a second sample of 250 primers shall be tested. If the combined number of defectives in both the first and second sample is 2 or more, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.3.1.

4.2.3.2.2 With black powder charge (see 3.5.2) - Major defect, Code No. 04007.

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4.2.3.2.2.1 Beginning with the first lot produced and continuing until three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance criteria specified, 25 primers shall be randomly selected for this test; if any primer fails to comply with the requirement the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.3.2.

4.2.3.2.2.2 After three consecutive lots have met the criteria of 4.2.3.2.1, 10 primers shall be randomly selected for this test; if any primer fails to comply with the requirement the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.3.2.

4.2.3.3 Moisture content of black powder (see 3.3) - Major defect - Code No. 70001.-A sample of one container charge assembly prior to assembly to the primer body shall be randomly selected from each eight hours production. The black powder shall be removed and tested as specified in 4.3.1. Any failure to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the eight hours production represented by the sample.

4.2.3.4 Chamber gage (see 3.6) - Major defect - Code No. 08001.-This test shall be conducted 100 percent. Any primer which fails to meet the requirements shall be removed from the lot.

4.2.3.5 Check test for deterioration (not applicable to new production).-This test is intended to prevent the loading of major ammunition items with primers that have deteriorated. The tests shall be performed on primers from each lot which has been stored under normal conditions for more than two years, or under adverse conditions for any period of time (see 6.4 and 6.5). If the specification for the ammunition item into which the primers are loaded does not require performance of the check test, the contracting officer should insert a check test requirement in the contract.

4.2.4 Inspection Equipment - Equipment Tabulation Number ET-8840362 identifies the inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed in this section. The contractor shall design inspection equipment in accordance with the instructions in paragraph 6.3.

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4.2.4.1 Government rights to documentation.-Inspection equipment drawings and lists provided and revised in accordance with the requirements of the ET may be used by DOD activities for design, procurement, manufacture, testing, evaluation, production and receiving inspection, overhaul, shipping, storage, identification of stock, ordering and storage of replacement parts, inspection of items at overhaul, general maintenance of equipment, construction, survey and whenever inspection equipment drawings are needed.

4.2.4.2 Supply and maintenance.-Supply and maintenance of the equipment listed on the ET shall be in accordance with Specification MIL-I-45607.

4.2.4.3 Government use of contractor's inspection equipment. The contractor shall make available to the Government all inspection equipment necessary for determining conformance with contract requirements. Personnel for operating the equipment and verification of its accuracy shall be supplied by the contractor for the performance of examination or test by the Government.

4.3 Test methods and procedures

4.3.1 Determination of moisture content of black powder.-The moisture content of the black powder shall be determined in accordance with the procedure specified in Specification MIL-P-223.

4.3.2 Non-functioning.-The primer less the black powder charge shall be assembled in the test fixture specified in 4.2.4. A steel ball approximately 1 19/32 inches in diameter and weighing 16.34 plus or minus 0.02 ounces shall be dropped on the firing pin from a height of 1 1/2 inches minimum. The drop height shall be measured as the distance between the bottom of the ball and the top of the firing pin. Any primer assembly that fires shall be classed defective.

4.3.3 Functioning.

4.3.3.1 Without black powder.-The primer assembly less the black powder charge shall be tested as specified in 4.3.2 except that the drop height shall be increased to 9 inches maximum. Any primer assembly that fails to fire shall be classed defective.

4.3.3.2 With black powder.-The primers shall be assembled with a dummy projectile at a Government proving ground and percussion fired from a gun for which the round is standard.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging

5.1.1 Level A.-Packaging shall be in accordance with dwg. 8860559.

5.2 Packing

5.2.1 Level A.-Packing shall be in accordance with dwg. 8860560.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.-Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.

b. Data cards. - Data cards shall be prepared for each lot in accordance with the information specified in Standard MIL-STD-1167.

6.2 Inspection code numbers.-The five digit code numbers assigned to the inspections herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government.

6.3 Inspection equipment. - The contractor shall design inspection equipment as required by the referenced inspection Equipment Lists (EL) in accordance with the instructions of paragraphs 6.3.1 through 6.3.5.

6.3.1 Inspection equipment lists. - Inspection equipment lists indicate the availability of inspection equipment designs by showing in the "number" column of the list of inspection equipment (Form SMUPA 1010) the numbers of drawings or Federal Stock numbers of existing equipment designs, or codes as indicated in paragraph 6.3.2. Design action required of the contractor is described in paragraphs 6.3.3 and 6.3.4. The contractor will be required to prepare detailed drawings in accordance with 6.3.4 for all the equipment coded as "Contractor Design" in the number column. These contractor designs must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.5.

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6.3.2 Inspection equipment list codes. - The inspection equipment as defined in 6.3.3 and 6.3.4 will be designated in the EL by the following codes:

CD - Contractor design on controlled contractor format and/or commercial equipment.
MU - Army design, mandatory for use.

6.3.3 Army designs. - Army designs are reflected on detailed drawings which completely depict all the information necessary for the fabrication of the item of inspection equipment. The contractor need provide no design when an Army design is listed for an item of inspection equipment. Army designs fall into two basic classifications: mandatory (designated "MU") and non-mandatory (indicated by drawing or Federal Stock Number). When an inspection equipment list references mandatory Army designs, the contractor shall comply with, and use these designs accordingly. The contractor may, however, in connection with non-mandatory designs, and with the approval of the Government, design alternate inspection equipment or use comparable commercial equipment to facilitate his operations. Such contractor prepared designs or commercial equipment selections must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.5.

6.3.4 Contractor designs. - Contractor designs are designs of inspection equipment for which the Government has assigned design responsibility to the contractor. Contractor designs shall be supported by detailed drawings which depict all information necessary to completely fabricate, calibrate and operate an item of inspection equipment. This requires that the necessary views, dimensions, materials, finish, notes, operating and calibration instructions be properly depicted in accordance with approved practices to the extent that further calculation or clarification will not be required. Unless otherwise specified, contractor designs may be developed on the format the contractor normally employs in his equipment design procedure provided such format reflects the detail and information specified above, subject to the following controls: All submitted contractor designs shall conform to MIL-D-1000, Category E, Form 2. Legibility and reproducibility shall permit conventional making of clearly understandable, high contrast reproductions. Contractors shall submit one copy of final designs as a rolled set. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.5.

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6.3.5 Submission of contractor designs. - Unless otherwise specified on the EL, all designs of equipment for inspection of defects classified as critical and major shall be submitted for approval to the Commanding Officer, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SMUPA-NDl. All other designs of inspection equipment shall be approved by the inspection element of the agency administering the contract; submission shall be as directed by the contracting officer. Partial submission of inspection equipment designs is permissible and encouraged. However, the Arsenal completion date for design review will be based on the date of the final submission of designs. Picatinny Arsenal design review will be accomplished normally within one month after receipt.

6.4 Cost of check test.-The contracting officer will arrange to have the contractor reimbursed for expense incurred in the performance of the check test.

6.5 Check test.

6.5.1 Non-functioning.-(See 3.4) The sampling plan for this test shall be in accordance with Table I. Any primer which fail to comply with the applicable requirement shall be classed defective. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.2.

TABLE I

Sample	Sample Size	Cumulative Sample Size	Combined Sample Acceptance Number	Rejection Number
First	20	20	*	2
Second	20	40	*	2
Third	20	60	0	2
Fourth	20	80	1	3
Fifth	20	100	1	3
Sixth	20	120	1	3
Seventh	20	140	2	3

*No acceptance on first or second sample.

6.5.2 Functioning (see 3.5.1).-The sampling plan for this test shall be in accordance with Table II. Any primer which fails to comply with the applicable requirements shall be classed defective. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.3.1.

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TABLE II

Sample	Sample Size	Cumulative Sample Size	Combined Sample Acceptance Number	Rejection Number
First	75	75	*	2
Second	75	150	0	3
Third	75	225	0	3
Fourth	75	300	1	4
Fifth	75	375	2	5
Sixth	75	450	2	5
Seventh	75	525	4	5

*No acceptance on first or second sample.

6.5.3 Moisture content of black powder.-A sample of 25 primers shall be selected for this test. The black powder shall be removed from the flash tube and the moisture content determined* in accordance with the method specified in Specification MIL-P-223. If the moisture content of any of the powder tested exceeds 0.7 percent, the lot of primers shall be rejected.

*Since black powder is hygroscopic, it is advisable to place the powder in a dry air-tight container immediately upon removal, and to run the determination as soon as possible thereafter.

6.6 Standardization agreement.-Certain provisions of this specification are the subject of international standardization agreement ABCA-Army-STD-150. When amendment revision, or cancellation of this specification is proposed, the departmental custodians will inform their respective Departmental Standardization Offices so that appropriate action may be taken respecting the international agreement concerned.

6.7 To extract means removal of the primer from the mechanism without tools and without impairing the functioning of the firing mechanism. Perforation of the percussion element shall not be cause for rejection unless metal removed by firing pin causes the firing mechanism to become unserviceable.

6.8 Metal parts separation.-Missing metal from the lip area (mouth of the primer) is considered a "burned through" area and not metal parts separation provided that such an area is not greater than 1/4 inch wide at the lip and does not extend more than 1/4 inch back from the lip.

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Custodian:
Army-MU

Preparing activity:
Army-MU

Project Number: 1390-A592

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PICATINNY ARSENAL
DOVER, NEW JERSEY 07801

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity *(as indicated on reverse hereof)*.

SPECIFICATION

ORGANIZATION *(Of submitter)* | CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NO. | QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED | DOLLAR AMOUNT
$

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES.

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)* | DATE

DD FORM 1 APR 63 1426 REPLACES NAVSHIPS FORM 4863, WHICH IS OBSOLETE PLATE NO. 15419

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